MySQL Practice Sheet: Wildcards with LIKE Operator

1. Concept Overview

In MySQL, the LIKE operator is used in a WHERE clause to search for a specified pattern in a column. It is often used with wildcard characters to make flexible search conditions.

Commonly used wildcards in MySQL:
• % (percent): Represents zero, one, or multiple characters.
• _ (underscore): Represents a single character.

2. Sample Table: Employees

EmpID	EmpName	Department	City
1	Amit Sharma	HR	Delhi
2	Ravi Kumar	IT	Mumbai
3	Anita Verma	Finance	Pune
4	Reena Kapoor	IT	Delhi
5	Aman Gupta	Admin	Chennai
6	Rohit Singh	Finance	Kolkata

3. Practice Queries

Q1. Display employees whose name starts with 'A'.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE EmpName LIKE 'A%';

Q2. Display employees whose city ends with 'i'.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE City LIKE '%i';

Q3. Display employees whose department contains the letter 'i'.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE Department LIKE '%i%';

Q4. Display employees whose name has 'a' as the second character.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE EmpName LIKE '_a%';

Q5. Display employees whose city starts with any character and then 'e'.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE City LIKE '_e%';

Q6. Display employees whose name does not contain the letter 'a'.
👉 SELECT * FROM Employees WHERE EmpName NOT LIKE '%a%';

4. Task

• Write 5 additional queries using LIKE and wildcards on the Employees table.
• Try patterns like names ending with a specific letter, starting with a letter, or containing certain letters.
• Use NOT LIKE to filter out specific patterns.